LEGACY

Successful devs

Vocabulary in context

1 Think of one or two developers or tech founders you consider successful. What makes them successful? Write your ideas below.

Who are they, and what makes them successful? (They can be famous people or someone from your team or community.)

Tu respuesta...

2 Read the article about three traits of successful developers.

Three traits of successful developers

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1. Vision

All successful developers know they won't **get anywhere** without a clear vision of what they want to build. Linus Torvalds had a vision for a free, open operating system that anyone could modify. He shared the first version online in 1991, and the project soon **got off the ground**. Today, Linux runs a large part of the internet's servers and Android smartphones.

David Heinemeier Hansson had a vision for a web framework that made developers happy, not just one that worked. He built Ruby on Rails while working on Basecamp and **got it under way** as an open source project in 2004. How Rails **got to be** one of the most influential web frameworks is a story many developers know. Both men changed their industries.

2. Persistence

Success in tech rarely comes easily. Stewart Butterfield built two online games, and neither became a lasting success. Still, neither failure **got in his way**: the tools from his first game became Flickr, and the chat tool from his second game became Slack. Many projects don't **get off to a good start**. Successful founders learn from their setbacks and **get on with** the work of rebuilding.

3. Passion

Many successful developers **get ahead** because they genuinely love the problems they're solving. Grace Hopper loved making computers accessible to humans, not just to mathematicians. She is credited with building the first compiler, and she **got to the top** of her field by doing something many people thought was impossible. Each of these people was successful, and none of them waited for permission.

Do the people you chose in Exercise 1 have the qualities described in the article? Explain.

Tu respuesta...

3 Complete each sentence with a get expression from the article. Use the words in parentheses to help you.

1. If you don't believe in what you're building, you won't (achieve anything) ______ in tech, and you won't (reach the highest level) ______ in your career.
2. Our new sprint will (begin to happen) ______ on Monday, and we want it to (have a successful beginning) ______.
3. You won't (move forward and do better than others) ______ in your career if you don't have a clear focus.
4. It (becomes) ______ frustrating when repeated setbacks (block your progress) ______.
5. Successful developers don't let anything (block them) ______. They (continue) ______ building after every setback.

Which of the sentences do you agree with most? Why?

Tu respuesta...

4 Match each get expression with its correct meaning.

1. get ahead	a. To begin well; to have a successful start.
2. get under way	b. To start a new project and get it working.
3. get in your way	c. To make progress in your career.
4. get off the ground	d. To start moving or happening.
5. get on with	e. To prevent someone from making progress.
6. get off to a good start	f. To continue doing something.

Grammar. Talking about all and none

Grammar box: all, both, each, every, neither, none of, no

Determiner	Use	Example
all / all of	plural or uncountable nouns	**All** successful developers need a vision. **All of** my teammates use Git.
both / both of	two people or things	**Both** projects got off to a good start. **Both of** these developers became successful.
each	one by one + singular noun	**Each** person on my team is successful in a different way.
every	all in a group + singular noun	**Every** team rejected the idea at first.
neither / neither of	not one of two	**Neither** product was a success at first. **Neither of** the founders gave up.
none of	not one of a group + the / my / these / them	**None of** these developers waited for permission. **None of** them had it easy.
no	not any + noun	**No** developer wants to give up. **No** bugs were found.

- **each / every** + singular noun + singular verb: Each person has a role. Every team has a goal.
- **both** = two. **neither** = not one of two. For more than two, use **all** / **none of**.
- **all** + noun: All developers... | **all of** + the / my / these / them: All of my teammates...
- **no** + noun: No developer... | **none of** + the / my / these / them: None of the developers...

5 Complete the second sentence so it means the same as the first one. Use a determiner from the grammar box.

1. Every successful developer knows they need a vision. → ______ successful developers know they need a vision.
2. The two men changed their industries. → ______ men changed their industries.
3. The two products didn't get off to a good start. → ______ product got off to a good start.
4. Not one of these developers waited for permission. → ______ these developers waited for permission.
5. Not a single developer got there alone. → ______ developer got there alone.

6 Choose the correct determiner to complete B's answers in each conversation. Then practice the conversations with a partner.

Conversation 1

A: Do you know any developers you consider really successful?

1. B: Yes. **a) Each** / **b) All** my close teammates are great engineers.
2. B: They work really hard, and **a) all of** / **b) every** their efforts have paid off.
3. B: **a) None** / **b) No** success comes without putting in the hours.
4. B: **a) None of** / **b) No** them had it easy, either.

Conversation 2

A: In what way are the developers you know successful?

5. B: Well, **a) both** / **b) each** person is successful in a different way. One is a great architect. Another is an incredible communicator.
6. B: But **a) all of** / **b) every** the developers I admire are doing work they actually care about.

Conversation 3

A: What do you think successful developers have in common?

7. B: They keep going after failure. Two engineers I know launched products that flopped, but **a) neither of** / **b) neither** their projects failed for good. They iterated and eventually shipped something people loved.

Conversation 4

A: What achievements are you proud of in your career so far?

8. B: I shipped my first open source library last year. I'm sure **a) every** / **b) all** developer wants that moment.
9. B: It wasn't easy. I only had two early reviewers, and **a) each** / **b) both of** them thought I'd abandon it.

7 Discuss the questions with a partner. Use at least two determiners from this lesson in your answers. Give examples when possible.

1. **Do you know any developers you consider really successful?**

Tu respuesta...

2. **In what way are the developers you know successful?**

Tu respuesta...

3. **What do you think successful developers have in common?**

Tu respuesta...

4. **What achievements are you proud of in your career so far?**

Tu respuesta...